# The Shade That Would Not Shift

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 13

The cloth shade caught at the edge of its channel. Nib began to push beside the glass, then noticed how little room his paw had. Lark found the shade's own handle in the guide picture. It was meant to move the shade without pressing on the pane.

“A shade with a stubborn edge,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “A handle with a useful job,” Lark replied calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cube**

“In shut and shade, s and h work together for one /sh/ sound,” Lark modeled softly. “Don't split the team into /s/ and /h/. Join sh, u, t for shut. Shade keeps the long a pattern we already know.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try shut, ship, shop, shade. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read shut on the guide strip,” Lark invited gently. “Which handle does its picture give the shade?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can shut a box. Sam can see a ship.**

“Who can see a ship?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes closing something?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark freed the little catch while Nib used the proper handle. The shade slid through its clear channel without scraping the glass. The caretaker lit the ordinary lantern inside its fixed housing. The crew left the shutter shut until the agreed signal was ready. Vent, frame, ring, tube, and shade now each did their own job.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write shut beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the clear channel and safe handle. Nib kept his paw away from the glass. The lantern was prepared, and the invitation still held the simple signal the neighbors were waiting for.